

RULES AND REGULATIONS

1. Eligibility

Participation is open to Diploma and Undergraduate students from Public (IPTA) and Private (IPTS) Higher Education Institutions in Malaysia. All participants must be Malaysian citizens.

2. Team Composition

Each team must consist of FOUR (4) students from the same university and ONE (1) supervising lecturer.

3. Supervisor Role

The supervising lecturer is expected to provide guidance and advisory support only, and not to be directly involved in the product development.

4. Registration & Fees

Registration must be completed through the official MDIT x DOSM 2025 portal. Each team is required to pay a non-refundable RM150 entry fee.

5. Official Receipt and Claim Procedures

The official receipt will be issued throughout the competition. It may be used by teams to claim the registration fee from their universities, subject to their internal procedures. Participants must manage their own claims with their universities, as the organizers will not provide assistance or take any responsibility.

6. Mandatory WhatsApp Group Participation

Upon confirmation of registration, participants must join the official WhatsApp group 'MDIT 2025 PARTICIPANTS' using the provided link. All official announcements and updates will be made through this group.

7. Mandatory Attendance

All participants are required to be present and actively involved in every session organized throughout the competition.

8. Briefing Attendance

At least one representative from each team must attend the official briefing session(s) conducted by the organizer. Failure to attend may lead to disqualification.

9. Team Member Changes

No team changes are allowed after the registration deadline unless approved by the organizing committee under exceptional circumstances.

10. Originality of Work

The final product must be developed from scratch and must not be based on or bound to any existing intellectual property.

11. Development Timeline

All projects must be completed within the competition's specified timeframe. Late submissions will not be accepted or evaluated.

12. Data Sources

Participants must use open and publicly accessible datasets. The use of fabricated, simulated, or fictional data is strictly prohibited. All data must be authentic, reliable, and sourced from credible platforms. Recommended data sources include (but are not limited to):

- OpenDOSM (Department of Statistics Malaysia)
- eStatistik
- data.gov.my (Malaysian Government Open Data Portal)
- World Bank Open Data
- Monthly Highlights and Statistics Dataset by Bank Negara Malaysia
- UN Data

The use of the Kaggle website is strictly prohibited throughout the duration of the competition.

13. Tools & Software

Participants are permitted to use any hardware and software of their choice in the development of their final product throughout the competition.

14. Use of Equipment

Participants are required to use their own ICT hardware and software throughout the competition.

15. Required Submissions

Each team must submit:

- a) The developed product or application (source files)
- b) A recorded presentation video
- c) A project report (template provided by organizers)

16. Data Submission Format

All datasets used must be uploaded in machine-readable formats (e.g., **.csv**, **.xlsx**) to the platform provided.

17. Final Submission

Once submitted, no changes or resubmissions are allowed. The final version will be evaluated as is.

18. Dashboard Accessibility

The final product must be delivered in dashboard form and must remain accessible until the evaluation process is complete.

19. Bonus Points

Extra points will be awarded to teams that develop the product as a website or mobile application.

20. Ethical Data Use

Participants must not use any personally identifiable or confidential data without permission. Plagiarism or using copied content (e.g., dashboards) will result in disqualification.

21. Intellectual Property Rights

Participants retain full ownership of their projects. However, the organizer reserves non-exclusive rights to showcase, publish, or exhibit the project for promotional or educational use, with proper credit to the team.

22. Prohibition of Harmful Software

Submissions must be free from harmful elements such as viruses, trojans, spyware, or any code that could damage or disrupt systems.

23. Inappropriate Content Prohibited

Submissions containing offensive, violent, defamatory, or insulting content

especially against the organizers or any unauthorized copyrighted material will be disqualified.

24. Violation of Rules

The organizer reserves the right to disqualify or cancel any team's entry if rules or submission requirements are violated.

25. Liability Disclaimer

The organizer will not be held responsible for any incidents, health issues, damages, or losses incurred during participation.

26. Mandatory Attendance for Finalists

Only the top 10 finalist teams are required to attend:

- **Live Pitching: at Pahang**
- **Closing Ceremony: at Pahang**

27. Finalists' Responsibility for Expenses

Finalist teams are responsible for all related costs, including travel, accommodation, lodging, and parking.

28. Final Decision by Judges

All decisions by the judging panel, including the selection of winners, are final and cannot be appealed.

29. E-Certificate Eligibility

E-certificates of participation will be issued only to participants who submit their final products within the deadline. Certificates will be emailed after the competition ends.

30. Personal Data Protection

All personal data shared with the organizers will be securely stored and used only according to competition rules, unless explicit consent is given for other purposes.

MDIT X DOSM 2025 JUDGING CRITERIA

Each team will be evaluated by a panel of expert juries. Scores will be based on the following key criteria:

Main Evaluation Criteria

A : Project Content (60%)

- Data Selection
- Introduction
- Literature Review
- Methodology & Data Analysis
- Findings & Results
- Conclusion
- Originality & Commercial Value

B. Project Presentation (40%)

- Quality of Presentation
- Subject Knowledge
- Ability to Answer Questions
- Teamwork & Collaboration
- Creativity & Innovation
- Time Management

Special Awards Categories

1. Pitching Excellence Award (Individual)

Awarded to the individual who delivers the most effective and engaging presentation, demonstrating clarity, confidence, good structure, strong audience connection, and appropriate pacing.

2. Critical Thinking & Defence Award (Team)

Recognises the team that shows excellent knowledge of their project, works well together, responds confidently to questions, handles feedback positively, and defends their ideas with strong logic and reasoning.

3. Innovation Excellence Award (Team)

Honours the team that showcases the most original and innovative ideas, with clear data organisation, impactful visual design, practical applications, and potential for scalability.